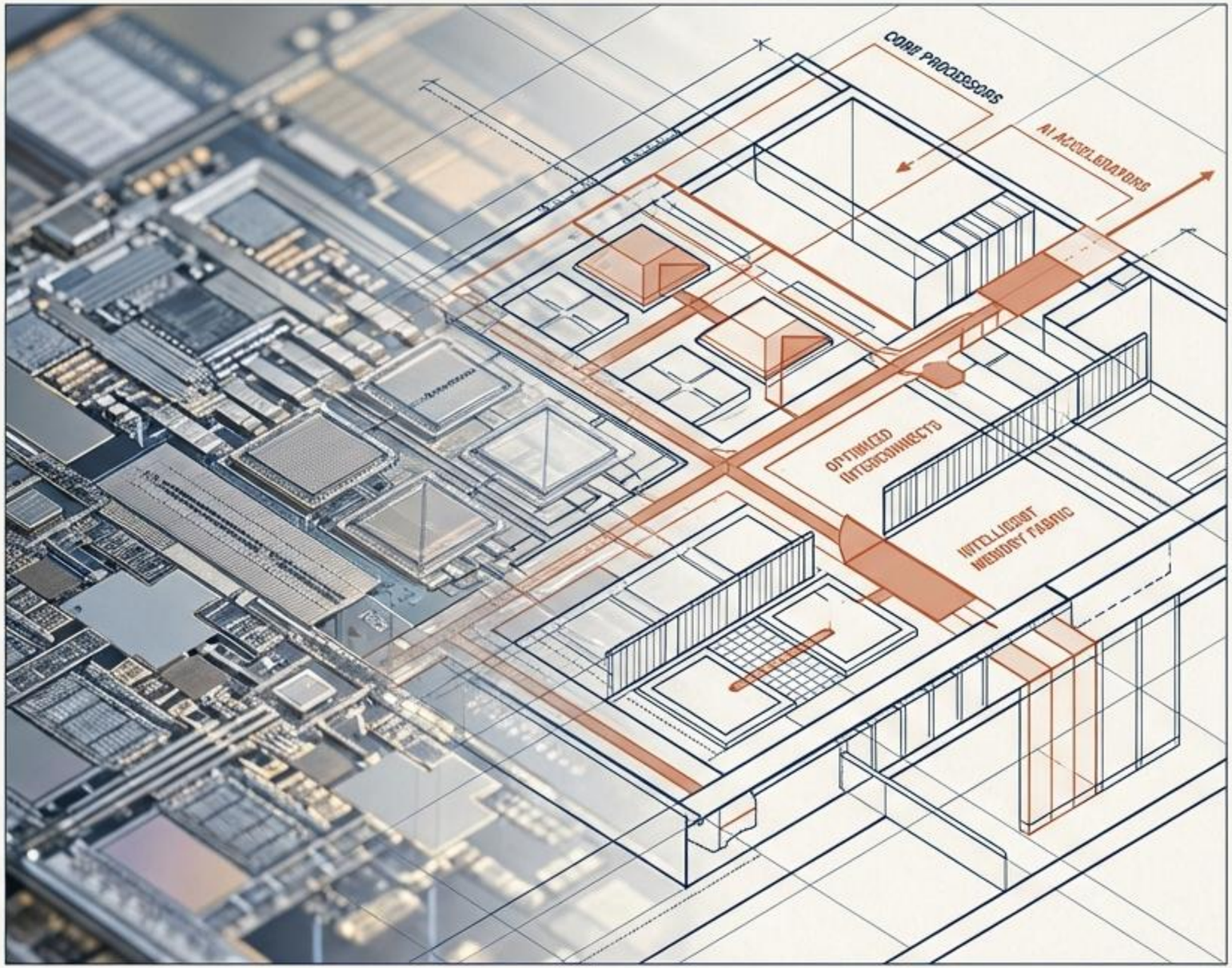
Learnlike®

Silicon Meets Artificial Intelligence

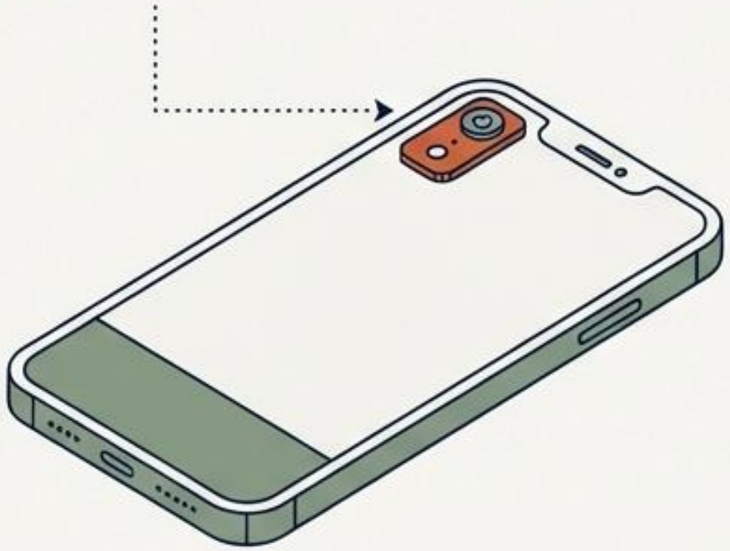
How machine learning is transforming the physical architecture of the future.

DEEPAK RAVIKUMAR
CEO,LEARNLIKE



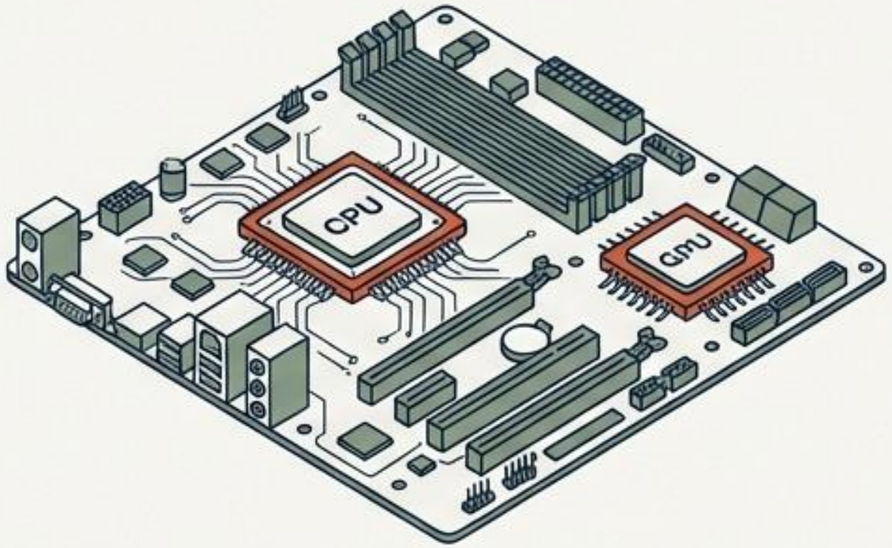
Application-Specific Logic vs. General Computing

ASIC (Application-Specific Integrated Circuit)



A chip containing millions of transistors designed for one particular task.

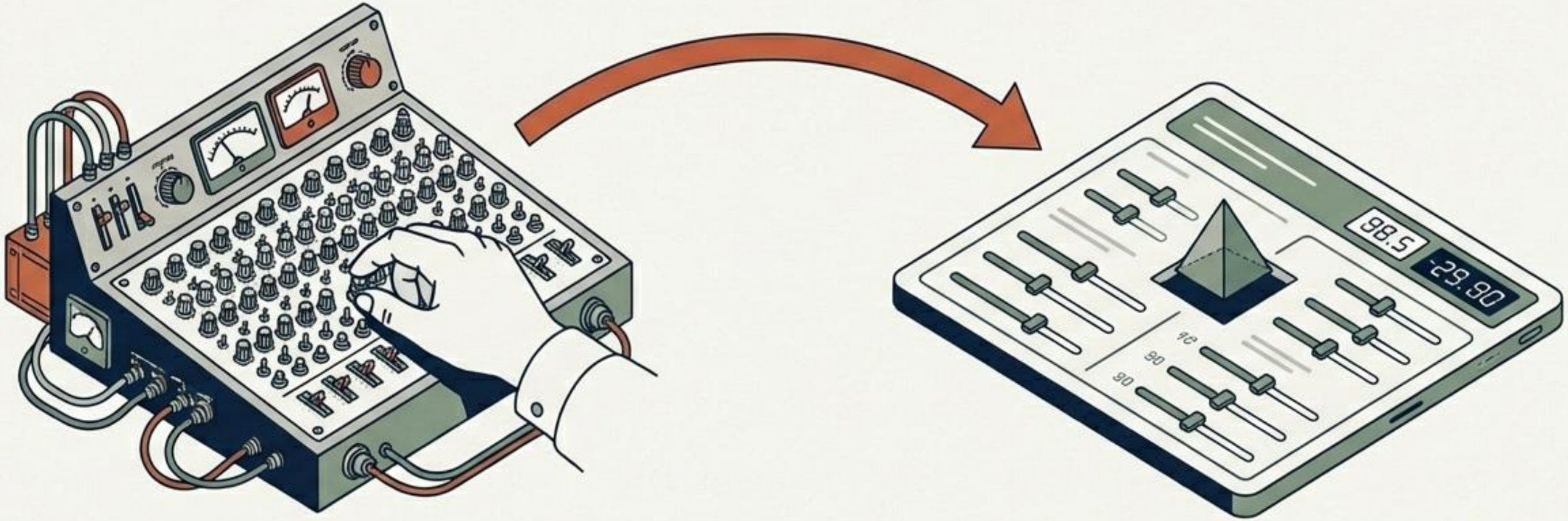
CPU / GPU



Built for general purpose computing or programmable graphics.

The ASIC Advantage: | Faster. | More power-efficient. | Smaller.

Automating the Silicon Blueprint



The Old Way

Humans manually tuning thousands of complex design parameters.

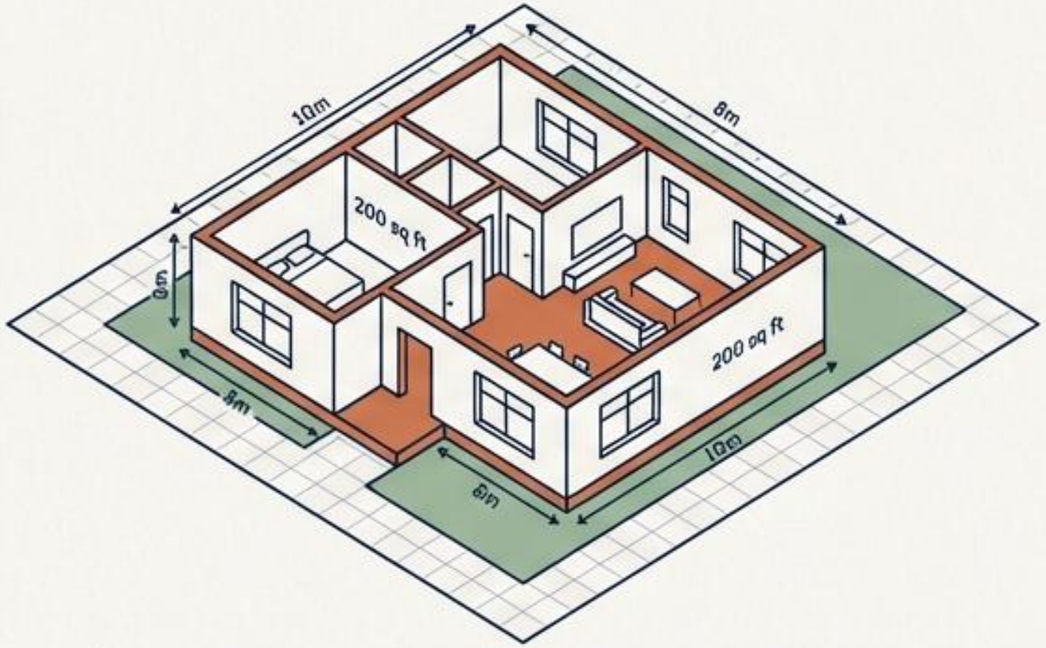
The AI Way

Machines learning patterns to make smart decisions automatically.

Design chips faster	Reduce errors	Optimize power and performance	Automate complex design steps

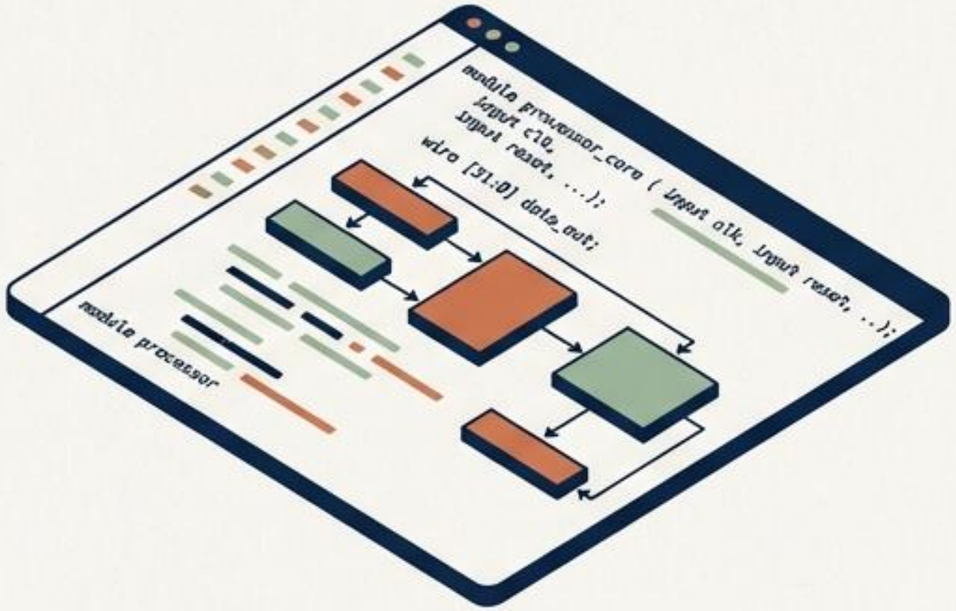
Laying the Architectural Foundation

Step 1: Specification



- Before building a house, you decide the rooms, size, and budget.
- Engineers define speed, power consumption limits, and area size.

Step 2: RTL Design (Register Transfer Level)



Register: Storage. Transfer: Moving data. Level: Abstraction.

Writing chip logic in HDL (Hardware Description Language) like Verilog or VHDL.

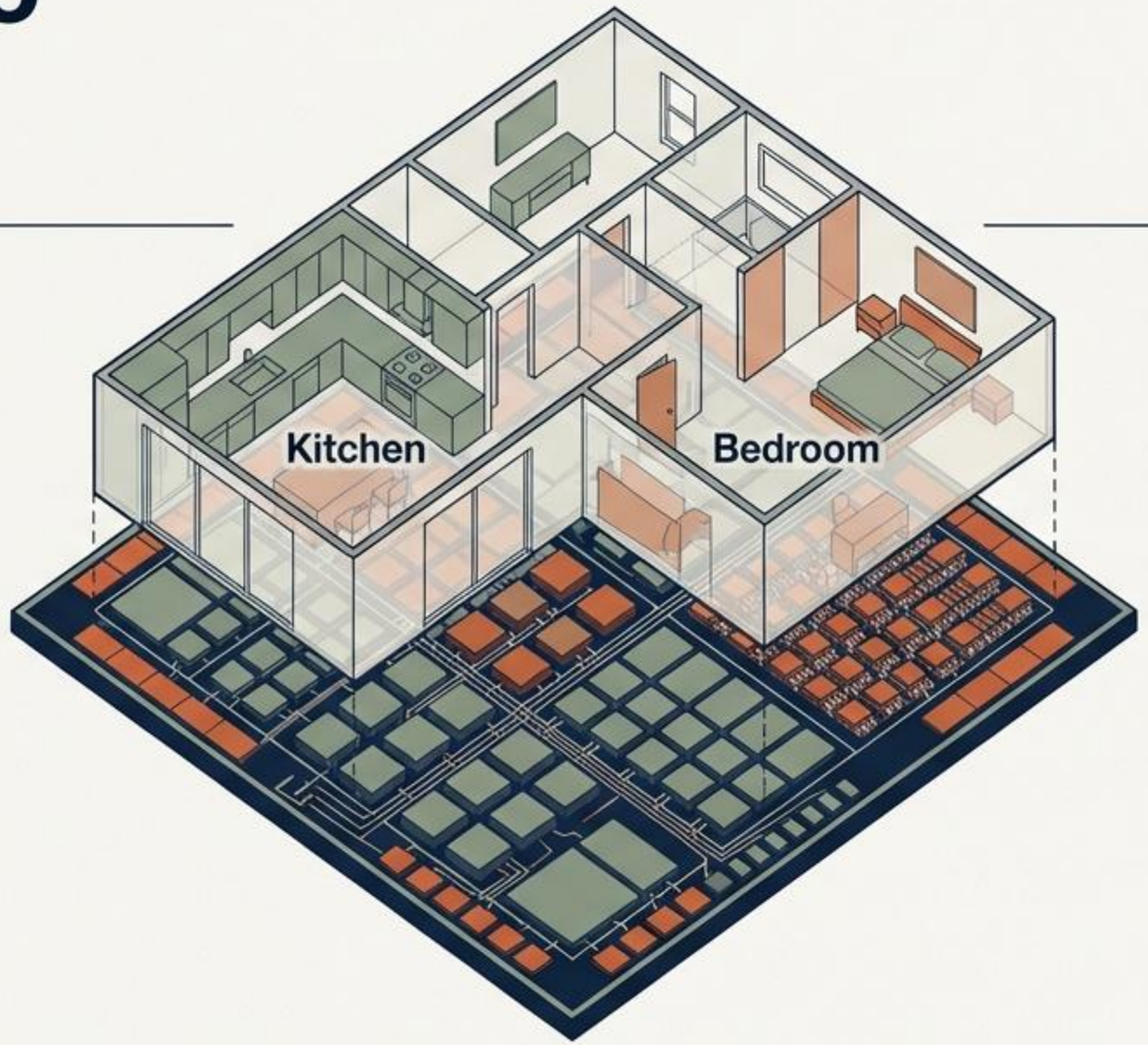
Translating Code into Physical Geometry

Step 3: Synthesis

Converting RTL code into real hardware logic structure using Logic gates (AND, OR, NOT) and Flip-flops.

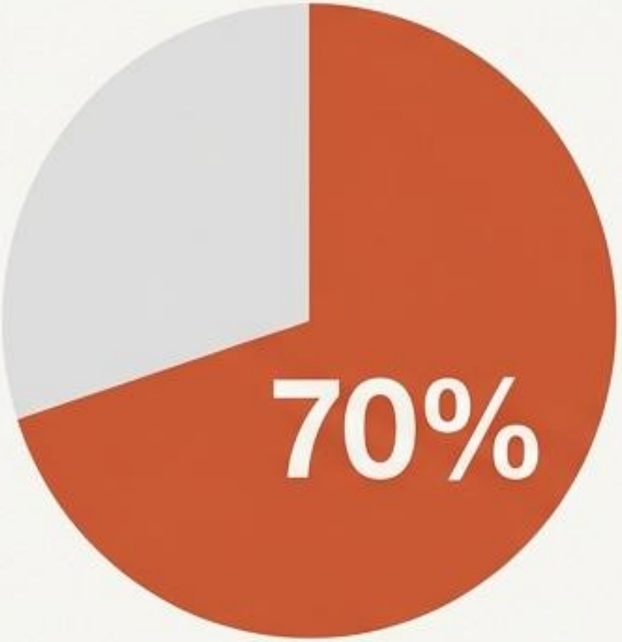
Step 4: Physical Design

- Floorplanning: Deciding where each block sits.
- Placement: Placing millions of small cells properly.
- Routing: Connecting cells using metal wires.
- Timing Closure: Ensuring signals move fast enough.



The Major Bottleneck and Final Fabrication

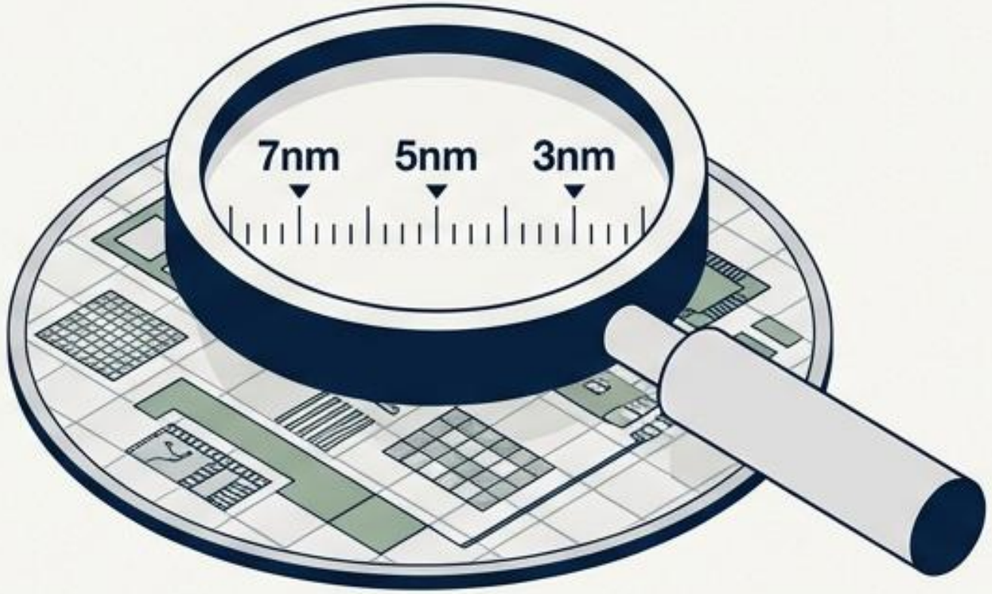
Step 5: Verification



Checking correct behavior via RTL, Functional, and Formal Verification.

Takes 60–70% of total design time.

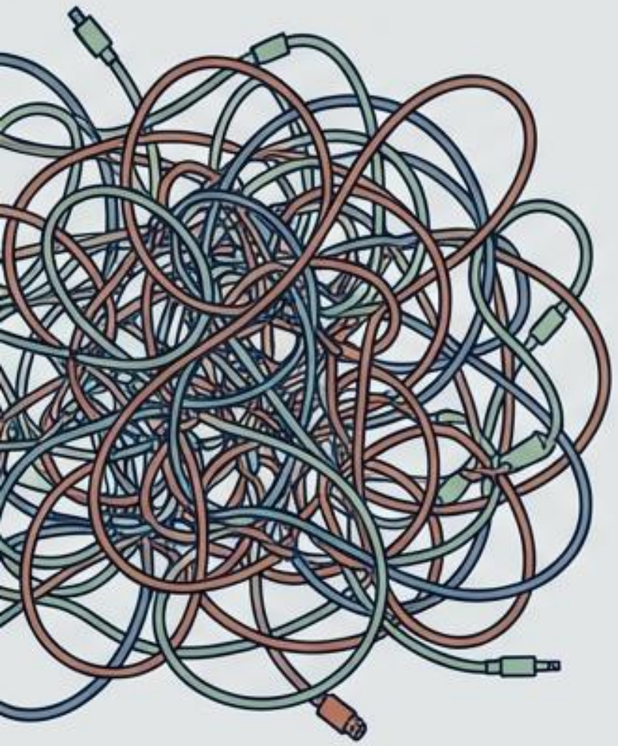
Step 6: Fabrication

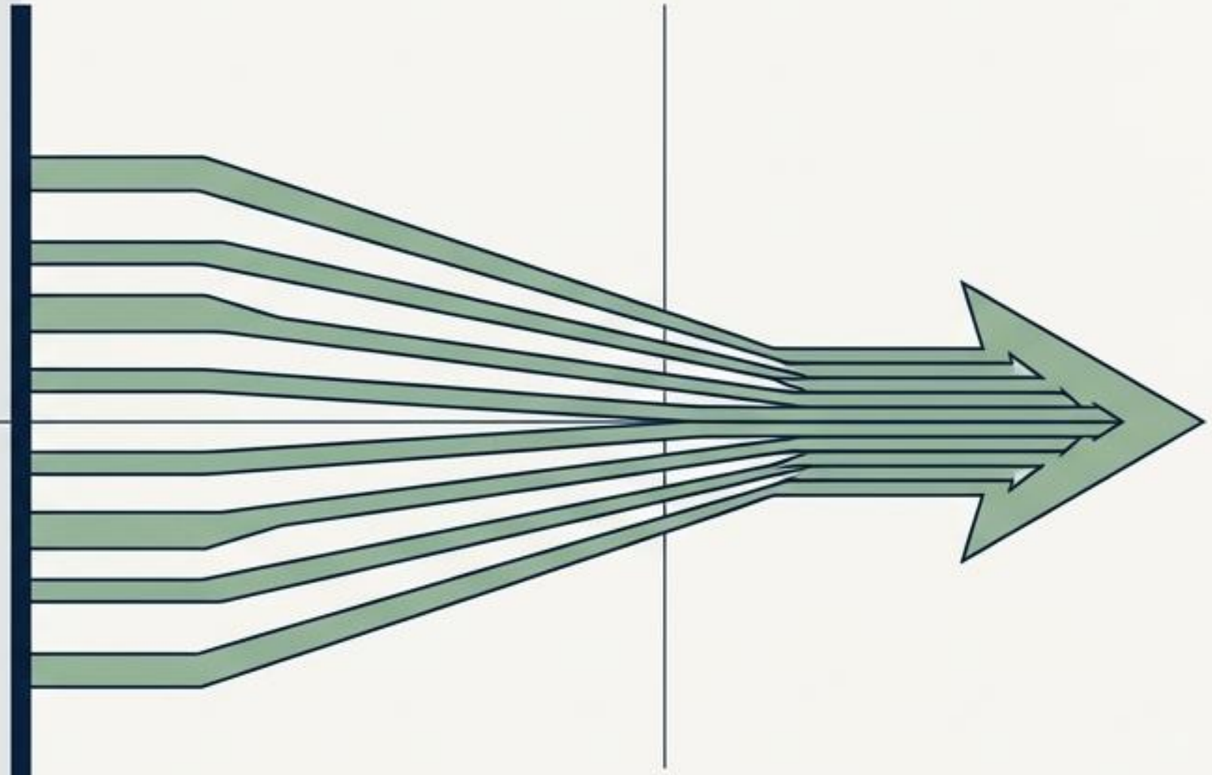


Manufacturing in a Fab at the nanometer scale.

One nanometer = one-billionth of a meter.
Smaller = faster and lower power.

The Breaking Point of Traditional Design





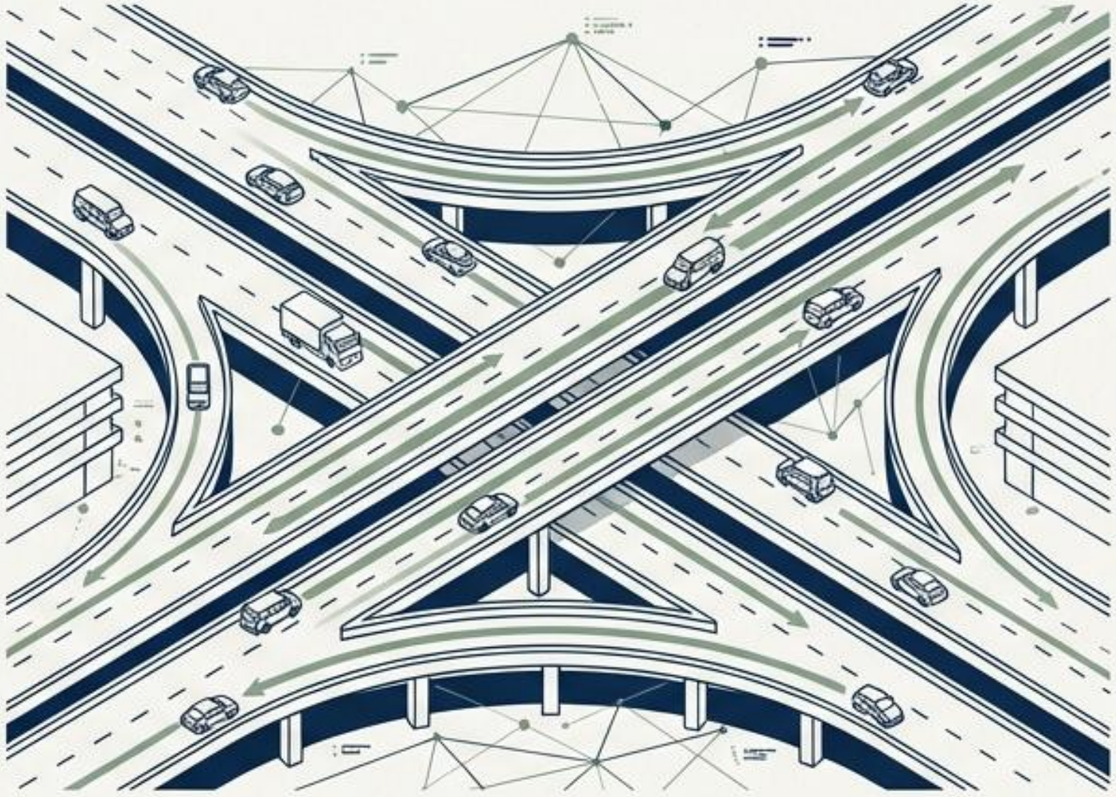
Without AI

- Design takes 12–24 months
- Intensely manual tuning
- High cost & endless iterations

The Catalyst

We need a system that simulates millions of possibilities instantly.

Visualizing the Routing Problem



Human Engineer

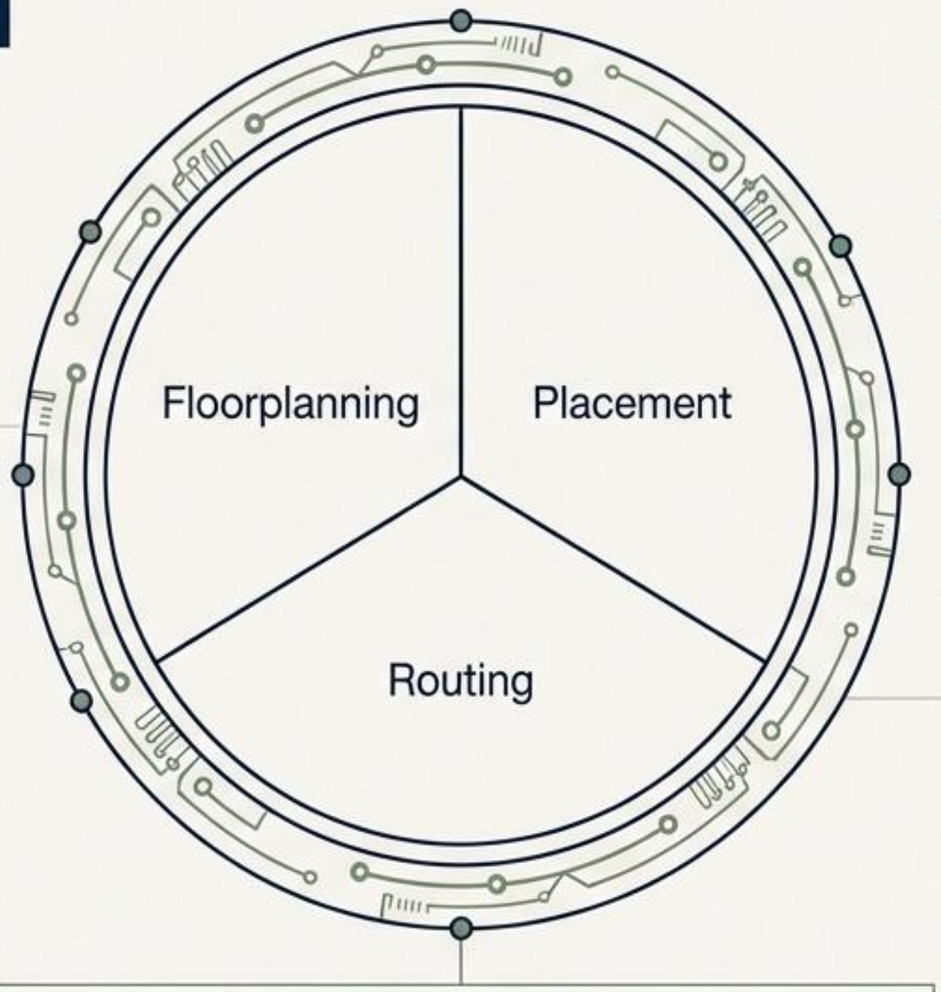
Places roads, adjusts signals manually, measures congestion after the fact.

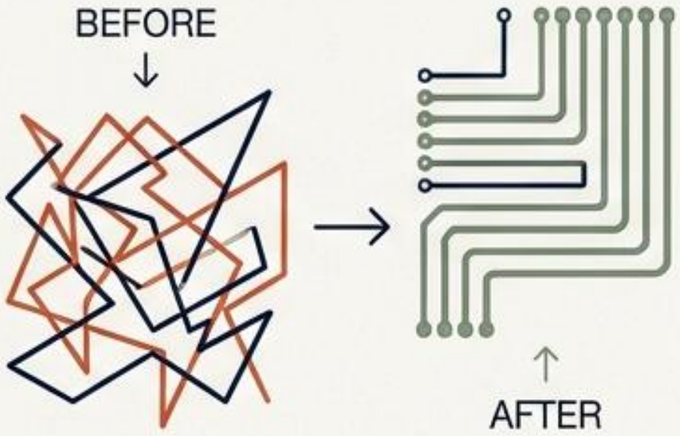
AI System

Simulates millions of possibilities, predicts traffic before it happens, optimizes layout automatically.

The exact same dynamic applies to routing millions of wires on a silicon chip.

Optimizing Physical Layout with AI





AI in Floorplanning

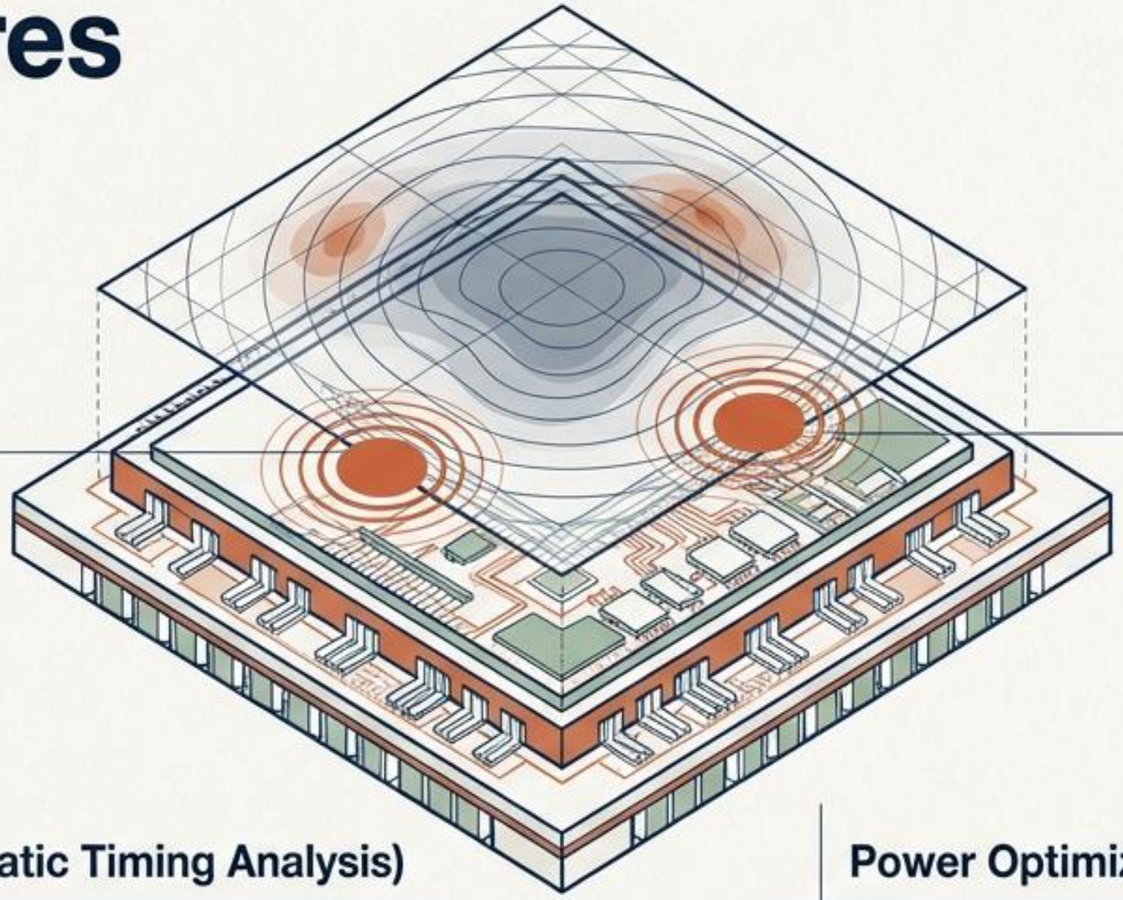
Learns from past designs to arrange blocks perfectly, reducing manual effort.

AI in Placement & Routing

Predicts congestion, optimizes wire routing, and reduces wire length.

Result: Drastically improves speed, power efficiency, and area utilization.

Predicting Timing and Power Failures



Timing Optimization (STA - Static Timing Analysis)

Checks if signals reach their destination on time.

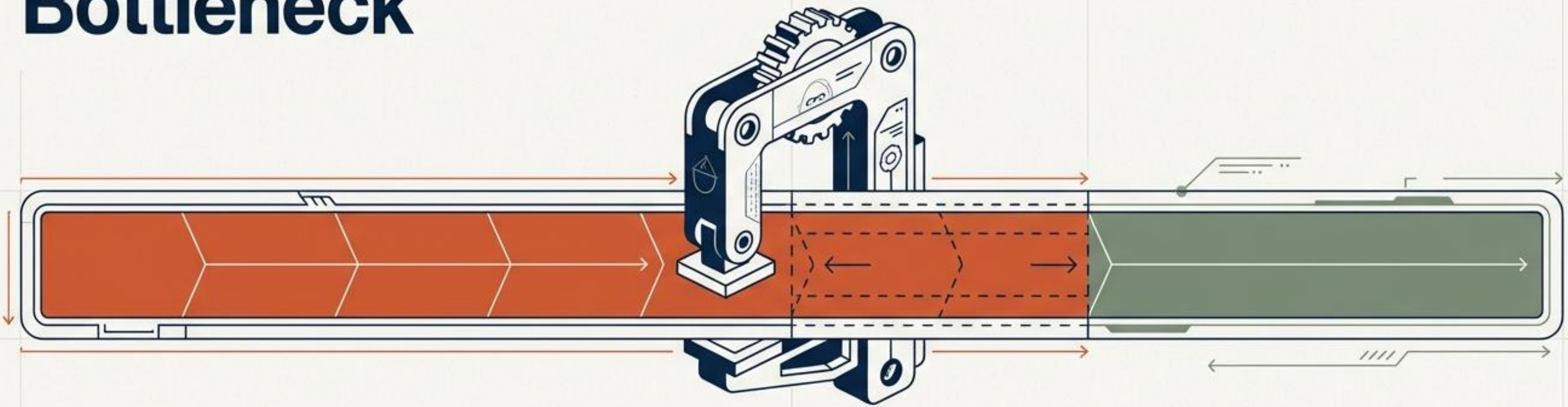
AI Advantage: Predicts timing violations early and auto-suggests fixes.

Power Optimization

Dynamic Power: Power used when switching.
Static Power: Leakage power.

AI Advantage: Predicts high-power regions and proactively targets them.

Cracking the Verification Bottleneck



Since verification consumes up to 70% of design time, AI intervention yields the highest ROI.

Test pattern generation
Georgia

Bug prediction

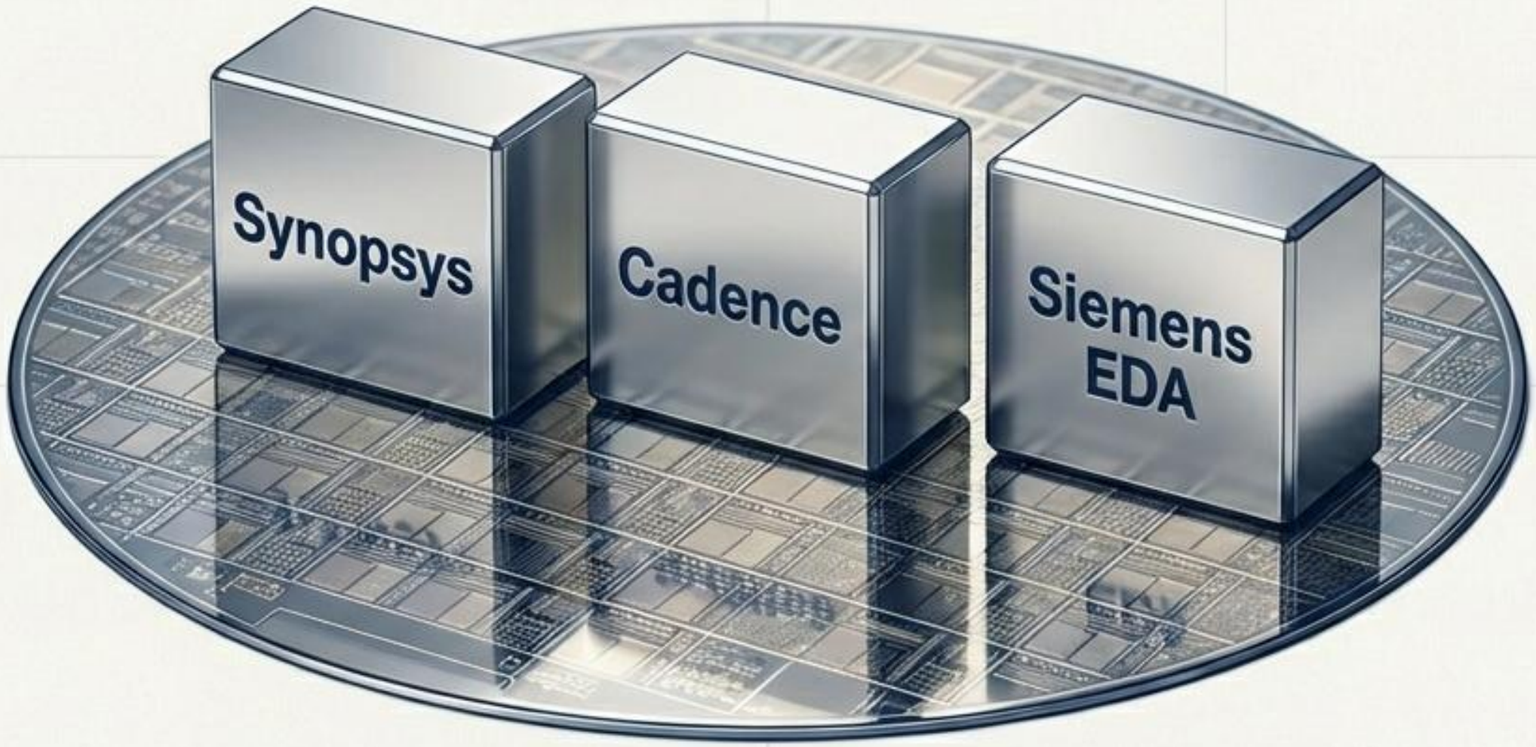
Coverage improvement

The Power, Performance, and Area Scorecard

Parameters	Human-Only Baseline	AI-Driven Design
Power	Standard consumption	Reduced via predictive targeting
Performance	Manual clock optimization	Faster clock speeds
Area	Standard packing	Tighter component packing & fewer routing errors

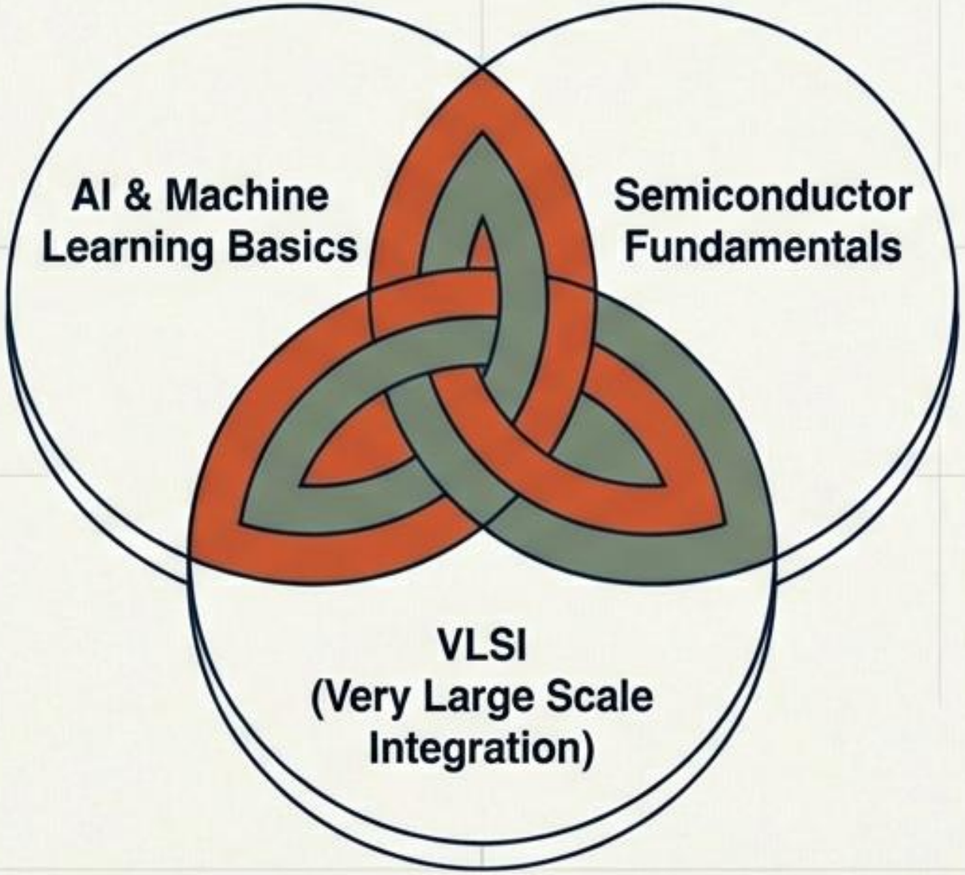
Key Results:
Reduced design cycle (down from 12-24 months), fewer human errors, lower overall cost.

Industry Reality Driven by EDA Giants



AI integration in chip design is no longer theoretical—it is the baseline standard for the companies building the software that builds the hardware.

The New Mandate for Future Engineers



Mastering a single domain is no longer enough. The future belongs to those who live at the intersection of physical silicon and machine learning.

The Comprehensive VLSI Cheat Sheet

Hardware Components

- **ASIC:** Application-Specific Integrated Circuit.
- **CPU:** Central Processing Unit.
- **GPU:** Graphics Processing Unit.
- **FPGA:** Field Programmable Gate Array.
- **SoC:** System on Chip.
- **CMOS:** Complementary Metal Oxide Semiconductor.

Software & Code

- **AI:** Artificial Intelligence.
- **ML:** Machine Learning.
- **EDA:** Electronic Design Automation.
- **RTL:** Register Transfer Level.
- **HDL:** Hardware Description Language.
- **VHDL:** Very High-Speed Integrated Circuit HDL.
- **IP:** Intellectual Property.

Processes & Metrics

- **PPA:** Power, Performance, Area.
- **STA:** Static Timing Analysis.
- **DRC:** Design Rule Check.
- **LVS:** Layout Versus Schematic.
- **GDSII:** Final fabrication file.

Screenshot to save for your next VLSI or hardware engineering interview.